

August

13



1961

Berlin Wall

To prevent people from leaving Soviet-controlled East Berlin for West Berlin (controlled by the UK, USA, and France), Soviet forces began to build a wall around West Berlin. It became a symbol of the Cold War, until it fell in 1989.

Also on this day

1512 The Spanish army conquered the capital city of the Aztec Empire, **Tenochtitlán** (in present-day Mexico), leading to Spanish rule in the region.

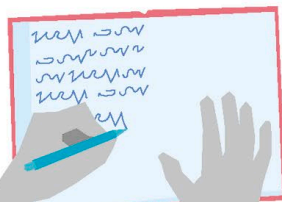
1918 **Opha May Johnson** of Indiana, USA, became the first woman to join the US Marine Corps when she enlisted during World War I.

2003 Canadian stunt artist **Scott Hammell** escaped from a straitjacket while hanging from a hot-air balloon 2,195 m (7,200 ft) above ground.

1976

Left-handers united

US soldier Dean R Campbell established International Left-Handers Day. This annual celebration of left-handed people is an occasion to raise awareness about the challenges they may face in their daily lives.



Olympic champion

2016

At the Olympic Games in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, US swimmer **Michael Phelps** won his 23rd Olympic gold medal. He has won more Olympic gold medals than any other athlete.



Born this day

1860 Annie Oakley, US sharpshooter. She travelled across the USA with the *Wild West* show, entertaining audiences with her shooting skills.

1899 Alfred Hitchcock, British film director, producer, and screenwriter. He directed more than 50 thrillers, gripping audiences worldwide.